

Potty Regression New Sibling — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

IDENTIFY THE REGRESSION TYPE

- ☐ **Identify which regression type matches your situation by looking at when accidents happen, how your child reacts, and what other signs are present.:** Identify which regression type matches your situation by looking at when accidents happen, how your child reacts, and what other signs are present.
- ☐ **Notice if accidents happen specifically when you're visibly busy with the baby, as this signals attention-seeking behavior that needs a different response approach.:** Notice if accidents happen specifically when you're visibly busy with the baby, as this signals attention-seeking behavior that needs a different response approach.
- ☐ **Check for medical symptoms like straining, very hard stools, blood in stool, or crying during bowel movements, since these require a pediatrician visit first.:** Check for medical symptoms like straining, very hard stools, blood in stool, or crying during bowel movements, since these require a pediatrician visit first.
- ☐ **If your child shows anxiety signs like new clinginess, sleep disruption, withholding, or regression in other areas, address the anxiety before pushing potty training.:** If your child shows anxiety signs like new clinginess, sleep disruption, withholding, or regression in other areas, address the anxiety before pushing potty training.

RESPOND BY REGRESSION TYPE

- ☐ **For normal developmental regression, stay completely neutral about accidents without punishment, praise, or reminders while waiting for your child's nervous system to settle.:** For normal developmental regression, stay completely neutral about accidents without punishment, praise, or reminders while waiting for your child's nervous system to settle.
- ☐ **Give completely neutral responses when accidents happen without expressing frustration or providing extended attention, since any reaction reinforces the behavior and prolongs the regression.:** Give completely neutral responses when accidents happen without expressing frustration or providing extended attention, since any reaction reinforces the behavior and prolongs the regression.

- **When your child asks for a diaper or refuses the toilet, honor the request without argument or pressure, allowing their nervous system to settle naturally.:** When your child asks for a diaper or refuses the toilet, honor the request without argument or pressure, allowing their nervous system to settle naturally.
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- **Provide at least 10 minutes of completely uninterrupted one-on-one time with your older child daily to reduce the need to seek attention through accidents.:** Provide at least 10 minutes of completely uninterrupted one-on-one time with your older child daily to reduce the need to seek attention through accidents.

REBUILD HABITS AND PREVENT PROLONGED ISSUES

- **Remove yourself from power struggles by stopping reminders, bribes, negotiations, and direct potty coaching during the acute regression phase.:** Remove yourself from power struggles by stopping reminders, bribes, negotiations, and direct potty coaching during the acute regression phase.
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- **Contact your pediatrician if your child is withholding bowel movements or showing constipation signs, since physical issues make regression significantly harder to resolve.:** Contact your pediatrician if your child is withholding bowel movements or showing constipation signs, since physical issues make regression significantly harder to resolve.
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- **Offer physical comfort and emotional support when your child appears anxious about potty, since connection helps their nervous system settle before potty habits will stick.:** Offer physical comfort and emotional support when your child appears anxious about potty, since connection helps their nervous system settle before potty habits will stick.
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- **Let go of urgency around the regression timeline, understanding that most cases resolve in 2-8 weeks when handled with low pressure and high connection.:** Let go of urgency around the regression timeline, understanding that most cases resolve in 2-8 weeks when handled with low pressure and high connection.
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